

Usability Test Descriptions

Prototype 1: Basic Mood Interface & Early Navigation

Focus: Initial understanding of home screen layout and mood creation.

Participants tested:

- Locating mood buttons
- Opening the side menu
- Trying to create or edit a mood

Findings:

- Users understood the three main mood buttons but struggled to identify the save function.
- Menu visibility was acceptable, but the connection between color preview and mood adjustment was unclear.
- Early confusion emerged around differentiating editing a mood versus creating a new one.

Prototype 2: Home/Room/Device Structure

Focus: Adding homes, rooms, and devices.

Participants attempted:

- Adding a home
- Adding rooms
- Assigning devices to rooms

Findings:

- Users expected a linear flow but encountered branching paths that felt unclear.
- Device binding was the most problematic step: participants were unsure when a device was successfully connected.
- The structure (Home → Room → Device) made sense conceptually but needed clearer cues and labeling.

Prototype 3: Simplified Mood Creation (Two Sliders)

Focus: Color selection system.

Tasks:

- Create a custom mood
- Adjust mood using two sliders (brightness + color approx.)

Findings:

- Users found the two-slider system too restrictive.
- Participants wanted finer color control and a more visual representation.
- The lack of rich feedback reduced confidence in mood creation.

Prototype 4: Full App Flow

Focus: Combined flow testing, following the recommended UX sequence.

Flow tested:

1. Add Home
2. Add Room
3. Connect Device
4. Create Mood
5. Edit Mood

Findings:

- HSV sliders improved satisfaction significantly.
- Autosaving changes was appreciated but sometimes created uncertainty (participants weren't sure when something saved).
- The Rooms/Devices toggle caused hesitation—its purpose wasn't obvious.

Prototype 5: Finalized Flow Screens (Add Home, Add Room, Mood Editing, Device Connection)

Focus: Polished interaction flow and clarity.

Tests included:

- Add Home/Room flow refinement
- Device connection journey
- Mood editing using final interface layout

Findings (synthesized from all flows):

- Clear improvements in visual hierarchy helped navigation.
- The mood editing screen offered strong clarity and feedback.
- Participants responded positively to the structured flow, though a few still hesitated when switching between rooms and moods.
- Terminology (“home,” “room,” “device”) needed consistent styling to avoid confusion.